

What follows is a review of the most popular of OSS video tools—viewers, editors, encoders etc. Before we begin, it is advisable to get all the codecs installed, either individually or by installing any of the all-in-one packs like the K-lite Mega codec pack. Get it from the essentials section in the *Digit* CD.

3.1 Players

Formats, Codecs And Other Undecipherable Stuff

FPS: for Frames per second. The number of movie frames displayed per second.

RESOLUTION: The number of horizontal and vertical dots that make up a display.

CODEC: Algorithm that is used to COmpress and DECompress a video/audio stream. Needless to say, a stream compressed using a codec needs the same codec to decompress it. Open source codec examples: Mpeg 1, Mpeg 2, Xvid, X264, etc. Other popular codecs include MOV, DivX, WMV, WMA, QT, RM

CONTAINER FORMAT: The file format used to pack data. Data (Audio, video, Text) can be compressed using any codec but should be packed in one of the many container formats. This would explain why it is possible to hear the audio even when the video codec is unavailable. Some containers are not compatible with certain codecs. Open Source container formats: Matroska, Ogg, etc.

ASPECT RATIO: The ratio of the width and height of a display. Most monitors use a 4:3 aspect ratio, whereas widescreen displays use the 16:9 aspect ratio.

AVI: Stands for Audio Video Interleave. So called because Audio and Video data are alternately arranged in the data stream. AVI is a container format.

DVD: Digital Versatile Disk. For the purposes of this article all DVD refers to Video DVD only. By default uses MPEG 2 for video compression and offers resolution of 720 X 576 (PAL) and 720 X 480 (NTSC). Audio can be compressed using other codecs.